Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Le Bénin lance un prix pour faire émerger de nouvelles solutions d'administration numérique** — We Are Tech Africa, 14 October 2026 BENIN

  Benin's government launched a national administrative simplification prize on 12 October, open to civil servants, citizens and businesses, for proposals to improve public services. Submissions run from 29 October to 12 November; selected ideas go to feasibility studies and possible trials, towards the target of all procedures online by 2030. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Egypt overhauls digital plan to win foreign investment** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026 EGYPT

  A workshop at the Cabinet's Information and Decision Support Centre recommended putting commercial registers and investor licensing on the Digital Egypt platform, wider use of national digital IDs and e-signatures, and backup connectivity for public networks running essential services. The recommendations were published by the State Information Service; no decision was announced. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **African Development Bank and UNDP Advance AI 10 Billion Initiative to Turn Africa's AI Potential into Productivity** — African Development Bank, 14 October 2026 AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and UNDP said the AI 10 Billion Initiative has moved to delivery after a UNDP mission to the Bank in Abidjan. It is to start in five countries and reach 20 by the end of 2027, arranging US$1 billion a year for ten years; no country, contributor or committed sum is named. *Also under AI.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Tanzania's TCRA Gives Telecom Providers 30 Days to Fix Infrastructure Faults** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's TCRA gave telecoms providers 30 days to correct faults found in inspections, among them unsafe cabling, damaged poles and unmarked infrastructure. Some providers must file full GIS maps of their networks, and new fibre installations now need the Authority's prior approval. *Also under Connectivity.*

Data protection

- **Nigeria's identity agency says its database is locally hosted and managed by staff** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

Nigeria's identity agency NIMC said the national identity database is hosted wholly in Nigeria, not in the cloud, and run by its own staff. It said about 63 government agencies have integrated with the database and 142 million people held a NIN in September 2026. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Storage.*

- **Nigeria to address red tape affecting digital trade under AfCFTA** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria is conducting a regulatory gap analysis with the World Bank Group to bring its pending digital economy bill and planned e-commerce policy into line with the AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol. With Egypt and Kenya, it is one of three pilot countries for ADAPT, a digital-trade infrastructure initiative of the AfCFTA Secretariat and the Tony Blair Institute. *Also under Regional collaboration and Data Exchange.*

- **Kenya's data protection regulator hosts Sri Lankan delegation for study visit** — Tech Review Africa, 14 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner is hosting Sri Lanka's Data Protection Authority for a three-day study visit led by Data Commissioner Immaculate Kassait. Sessions cover compliance, complaints, investigations and enforcement, and automation of the office's work.

- **Govt probes mass WhatsApp takeovers in Zimbabwe** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera said her ministry has opened a multi-agency investigation, including the police Cyber Crime Division, into a wave of WhatsApp Business account takeovers. It will examine whether personal or financial data was compromised and the role of SMS termination aggregators, and is engaging Meta and the affected mobile operator. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

Regional collaboration

- **Serikali yaweka mkazo teknolojia kuboresha huduma za posta, usafirishaji** — Mwananchi, 14 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Deputy ICT minister Switbert Mkama opened the East African Communications Organisation's fifth annual postal and logistics meeting in Arusha on 14 October. He named Tanzania's national address system, NAPA, as a tool for parcel delivery and access to digital services, and called for regional cooperation on payments, logistics and technical standards. *Also under Registries.*

- **Senegal shares digital transformation experience with Central African delegation** — Tech Review Africa, 14 October 2026 CAR SENEGAL

  Sénégal Numérique (SENUM SA) hosted a delegation from the Central African Agency for Digital Development, accompanied by the World Bank, on a study mission. Topics included information-system governance, cybersecurity operations centres, the national backbone, digital identity and interoperability, with a visit to the Diamniadio data centre. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **INEC moves to implement AI guidelines for elections** — Daily Trust, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA WEST AFRICA

  The ECOWAS Network of Electoral Commissions (ECONEC) has adopted guidelines on the use of AI in elections, validated at meetings on 12 and 13 October, its permanent secretary Serigne Mamadou Ka said during a visit to INEC in Abuja. The visit concerned implementing them across West African election bodies; the text has not been published. *Also under AI and Standards.*

- **Ghana, Rwanda, Nigeria test new cross-border digital payment systems** — Graphic Online, 14 October 2026
  GHANA RWANDA NIGERIA

  Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Asiama said on 13 October that the bank is testing cross-border payment interoperability with Rwanda and Nigeria across CBDCs, stablecoins, bank accounts and mobile wallets, with the aim of moving to live services on rails such as PAPSS. He said Ghana's mobile money transactions passed one billion in a month for the first time in August 2026, worth GH¢519 billion, and reported fraud cases rose 48% in 2025. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **African telecom regulators advance digital policies for the benefit of their citizens** — iPRIS, 14 October 2026
  SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The iPRIS programme, run by SPIDER and Sweden's PTS, held its eighth cohort's African phase in Nairobi from 5 to 9 October with regulators from Liberia, Namibia, Mauritius, Sierra Leone, Tanzania and Zimbabwe. Each presented a planned regulatory change; Liberia's authority switched its project from 5G spectrum guidelines to licensing private networks. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Nigeria to address red tape affecting digital trade under AfCFTA** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026
  NIGERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Standards

- **INEC moves to implement AI guidelines for elections** — Daily Trust, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA WEST AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **امضاء اتفاقية شراكة إطارية بين وزارة التشغيل و "اتصالات تونس" في مجال الاتصالات والتحول الرقمي** — Assabah News, 14 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Tunisia's Ministry of Employment and Vocational Training signed a five-year renewable framework agreement with Tunisie Telecom on 14 October. The operator is to connect employment offices and training centres to fibre, install AI labs in vocational-training centres and host a distance-training system in its national data centre. *Also under Training and skills and AI.*

- **Telecom Egypt expands subsea, terrestrial infrastructure for global traffic** — ETDatacenters, 14 October 2026
  EGYPT

  Telecom Egypt chief executive Tamer El Mahdi set out the company's investment in subsea and terrestrial routes, including the 200km Sharm El Sheikh-Taba cable agreed in September and due in service late next year. He said the company has set up a separate entity for its data-centre business and that its transit capacity exceeds 330Tbps. *Also under Data Storage.*

- **Q-KON, SISTEC launch sovereign satellite service for Angola** — CAJ News Africa, 14 October 2026 ANGOLA

Q-KON and SISTEC opened a point of presence in Luanda for the Twoobii OneWeb low-Earth-orbit satellite service, hosted at SISTEC's premises. It gives in-country data breakout with local IP addresses alongside Eutelsat OneWeb's Angolan gateway, and is sold to banks, government, defence and enterprises. *Also under Digital sovereignty*.

- **Government to audit 2,016 community network sites – Communications Minister** — MyJoyOnline, 14 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister Samuel Nartey George said the government will commission an independent audit of 2,016 community network sites inherited under an existing contract, to establish which are complete and working. He made the statement after inspecting four solar-powered rural telephony sites in Sekyere Afram Plains District on 13 October, which he said should be upgraded from 3G to 4G. *Also under Rural digital data capture*.

- **Ghana Directs GIFEC to Expand Rural Connectivity and Accelerate Network Upgrades** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026 GHANA

  After inspecting rural telephony sites on 13 October, Ghana's communications minister directed GIFEC to extend service to three more communities in Sekyere Afram Plains. The government is also working with MTN Ghana on 800 new sites at locations proposed by MPs. *Also under Digital divides*.

- **Gabon : Airtel optimise son réseau 4G en prévision de la 5G** — Agence Ecofin, 14 October 2026 GABON

  Airtel Gabon and ZTE announced on 13 October the commercial deployment of FDD+TDD Massive MIMO on Airtel's 4G network in Gabon, presented as preparation for 5G. The regulator ARCEP discussed the conditions for 5G with Airtel Gabon and Moov Africa Gabon Télécom in December 2025.

- **Cameroon's CAMTEL, SIC Sign Agreement to Bring Fibre Internet to Public Housing - Business in Cameroon** — Business in Cameroon, 14 October 2026 CAMEROON

  CAMTEL and the state housing developer SIC signed a framework agreement in Yaoundé to connect SIC estates to fibre, starting with about 40 households out of more than 30,000 SIC clients. Subscriptions start at CFAF 15,000 a month with CFAF 25,000 installation, and new SIC buildings are to be prewired. *Also under Access to services*.

- **Tanzania's TCRA Gives Telecom Providers 30 Days to Fix Infrastructure Faults** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Data Storage

- **Nigeria targets 300% surge in data centre capacity by 2031** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The chairman of Nigeria's ruling party said industry and government aim to raise data-centre capacity from about 50 MW to 200 MW of IT load within five years. He said power and water supply will decide which facilities last, and that cloud sovereignty should not turn into protectionism. *Also under Energy and Digital sovereignty*.

- **Telecom Egypt expands subsea, terrestrial infrastructure for global traffic** — ETDatacenters, 14 October 2026 EGYPT

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Energy

- **Nigeria targets 300% surge in data centre capacity by 2031** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026
  NIGERIA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Cybersecurity

- **Nigeria, Ghana in spotlight as Meta removes 3.7m accounts in scam crackdown** — Vanguard, 14 October 2026
  NIGERIA GHANA

  Meta removed more than 3.7 million Facebook and Instagram accounts, Pages and Groups linked to West African scam networks, in an operation led by the UK National Crime Agency with the US DOJ and FBI. Nigerian police arrested nine people and seized 53 devices; Ghanaian police arrested 19 near Accra and identified 117 trafficking victims made to work in scam operations.

- **Free cyber crime victim helpline launches** — ITWeb South Africa, 14 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  MiDO Academy and the UK charity The Cyber Helpline, funded by Amazon Web Services, began a 12-month pilot of a free, 24-hour cyber crime victim helpline in South Africa for anyone aged 13 or over. Supervised MiDO students answer calls and refer victims to banks, the police and mental health services. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Govt probes mass WhatsApp takeovers in Zimbabwe** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Data protection.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **رئاسة الحكومة: يتم حاليا العمل على استكمال تركيز منصة لتبادل المعطيات بين الهياكل العمومية** — Al Chourouk, 14 October 2026
  TUNISIA

  Tunisia's Presidency of the Government said in a written answer to MP Fatma Mseddi that a platform for real-time, secured data exchange between public bodies is still being completed. It said the same of the national administrative-procedures platform, intended as a single point of access for procedures. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Aviation : le Gabon déploie un système numérique d'analyse anticipée des passagers** — wearetech.africa, 14 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's transport minister Ulrich Manfoumbi Manfoumbi visited Securiport LLC's installation at Libreville's Léon-Mba airport on 12 October to speed up the start of an API-PNR passenger data system. The US firm holds a concession signed in May 2026 for Libreville, Port-Gentil and Mvengué airports, funded by a USD 30 levy per international passenger set in June. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Nigeria to address red tape affecting digital trade under AfCFTA** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026
  NIGERIA

Summarised under Data protection.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Passeports biométriques : le centre d'enrôlement de Ziniaré opérationnel** — Sidwaya, 14 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Burkina Faso's Security Ministry opened biometric passport enrolment at the regional police directorate in Ziniaré on 13 October, part of extending mobile enrolment kits to every region. Applicants no longer need to travel to Ouagadougou or Bobo-Dioulasso; the AES passport costs 50,000 FCFA and takes two weeks. *Also under Access to services.*

- **DIGITALIZAÇÃO: Novo centro de emissão de documentos é uma realidade** — Jornal Notícias, 14 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  President Daniel Chapo opened Centro Pronto in Maputo on 14 October, a centre that issues identity cards, passports, DIRE residence documents, driving licences and residence permits in one place. It was launched at the Citizen Connect Africa conference. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **DCI rolls out biometric clearance to diplomats** — The Standard, 14 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Directorate of Criminal Investigations extended its biometric police clearance certificate service to diplomats. The MBIS system behind it, launched on 23 July, linked 26 of 63 application centres by September; the DCI says processing has fallen from 14 days to same-day. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Nigeria's identity agency says its database is locally hosted and managed by staff** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **Egypt overhauls digital plan to win foreign investment** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026 EGYPT

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026 KENYA

  Airtel Money plans to launch a Mastercard prepaid virtual card linked to its wallets in Kenya, competing with Safaricom's M-PESA GlobalPay. Communications Authority figures put M-PESA's mobile money share at 88.8% and Airtel Money's at 11.1% in June 2026; Airtel has issued more than 875,000 virtual cards in Uganda, Zambia and Tanzania since 2025. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **Ghana, Rwanda, Nigeria test new cross-border digital payment systems** — Graphic Online, 14 October 2026 GHANA RWANDA NIGERIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Registries

- **MPs Order Detention of Two Auditors Over Unaudited Digital Number Plate Project** — Nile Post, 14 October 2026 UGANDA

Uganda's parliamentary Physical Infrastructure Committee ordered two directors of the Office of the Auditor General detained after they said the digital number plate project (ITMS) has not been audited since it began in 2021. The Auditor General said the project was classed as security-related and is financed by the Russian firm Joint Stock Company Global Security; motorists pay over Shs750,000 a plate. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Serikali yaweka mkazo teknolojia kuboresha huduma za posta, usafirishaji** — Mwananchi, 14 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Sectoral management information systems

- **Gov't Launches Upgraded GBV Information System to Strengthen Survivor Services** — Liberian Observer, 14 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia's Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection launched an upgraded Gender-Based Violence Information Management System with UNFPA support under the EU-backed Spotlight Initiative 2.0. It covers incident reporting, survivor case management and referrals; UNFPA handed over 40 tablets, a server and four laptops.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **2027: I've handed everything over to God, says INEC chairman** — Vanguard, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

  INEC chairman Joash Amupitan told a Yiaga Africa forum on AI and democracy in Abuja that the 2027 election will involve more than 103 million registered voters at 176,846 polling units. He said INEC has received additional BVAS devices, its nomination portal has processed more than 15,000 nominations from 22 parties, and voter registration is now online. *Also under AI*.

- **رئاسة الحكومة: يتم حاليا العمل على استكمال تركيز منصة لتبادل المعطيات بين الهياكل العمومية** — Al Chourouk, 14 October 2026 TUNISIA

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Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

- **Government to audit 2,016 community network sites – Communications Minister** — MyJoyOnline, 14 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Technology

AI

- **Ghana's Sam George presents 2,000 laptops to KNUST as One Million Coders programme shifts focus** — Tech Review Africa, 14 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister gave 2,000 more laptops to KNUST, adding to 500 given earlier, and said the One Million Coders Programme will now target third- and final-year students instead of first-years. He visited the university's Responsible AI Lab, which drafted the National AI Strategy launched in April 2026. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Ghana must prioritise home-grown AI solutions to meet national needs – UNDP** — MyJoyOnline, 14 October 2026 GHANA

  UNDP deputy resident representative Shaima Hussein urged Ghana to favour locally built AI solutions at the opening of a three-day Digital and AI Champions training for civil servants in Accra. The programme, run with the communications ministry and funded by Japan, aims to certify 50 officers and train 40 chief directors and 120 directors. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Africa risks falling further behind without urgent action on AI and digital governance – Dr Johnson Asiama** — MyJoyOnline, 14 October 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  At the IMF African Caucus in Bangkok on 14 October, Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Asiama asked the Fund to expand capacity support for African AI governance, supervisory technology and cybersecurity. He also asked it to include AI in its surveillance and Financial Sector Assessment Programs, and to help finance digital public infrastructure. *Also under Digital sovereignty.*

- **امضاء اتفاقية شراكة إطارية بين وزارة التشغيل و "اتصالات تونس" في مجال الاتصالات والتحول الرقمي** — Assabah News, 14 October 2026 TUNISIA

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ICT Industry

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  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Innovation ecosystem

- **Cascador and Sterling launch $200 million fund to derisk startup loans** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Cascador and Sterling Bank announced the SME Credit Backstop, a planned USD 200 million first-loss fund to support up to USD 1 billion of bank loans to Nigerian start-ups and SMEs nominated by their investors. Underwriting is to use AI; the fund's capital has not yet been raised.

Capacity

Training and skills

- **Madagascar Partners with Orange to Strengthen Digital Skills and Vocational Training** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar's Ministry of Technical Education and Vocational Training signed a partnership with Orange Madagascar on 8 October on digital-skills training and matching vocational courses to labour-market demand. No budget or targets were given.

- **امضاء اتفاقية شراكة إطارية بين وزارة التشغيل و "اتصالات تونس" في مجال الاتصالات والتحول الرقمي** — Assabah News, 14 October 2026 TUNISIA

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

- **Ghana Directs GIFEC to Expand Rural Connectivity and Accelerate Network Upgrades** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026 GHANA

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Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

- **Q-KON, SISTEC launch sovereign satellite service for Angola** — CAJ News Africa, 14 October 2026 ANGOLA

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- **Nigeria targets 300% surge in data centre capacity by 2031** — The Guardian Nigeria, 14 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.